



ONE SHOT

REVISION SERIES

CLASS 10

CIVICS

POLITICAL PARTIES



Introduction

Why do we need Political Parties? 🤔

Political Parties



Meaning

- A political party is a group of people who come together to contest elections and hold power in the government. They agree on some policies and programmes for the society with a view to promote the collective good.
- Parties reflect fundamental political divisions in a society. Parties are about a part of the society and thus involve **Partisanship**.
- A political party has three components -
 - The leaders
 - The active members
 - The followers

Function of a Political Party



- Parties contest election.
- Parties put forwards different policies and programmes to choose from.
- Parties play a decisive role in making laws for a country.
- Form and run government.
- Plays the role of opposition.
- Political parties shape public opinion.
- Parties provide people access to government machinery and welfare scheme.

Necessity of Political Parties

Can modern democracies exist without political parties. ➡

No



Without parties, every candidate in the election will be independent.

- No major consensus.
- No promises for any major policy changes can be made.



Why?



- No candidate will be responsible for the country as a whole, elected **candidate will be accountable for their constituency.**
- The rise of political parties is directly linked to the emergence of **representative democracies.** ➡ Parties are a necessary condition for a democracy.

How Many Parties Should We Have

Freedom to form political parties ➡ More than 750 parties registered with Election Commission of India.



Are these all parties serious contenders 🤔

Different Party System**One-Party System**

- Only one party is allowed to control and run the government.
- China
- Good or Bad 🤔

Two-Party System

- Power usually changes between two parties.
- U.K. and U.S.A.

Multi Party System

- When several parties contest and have chance of coming to power.
- Coalition government
- India.

Which of these is better?

- This is not a very good question, party system evolves over a long time, depending on the nature of society, its social and regional divisions, its history of politics and its system of elections.
- No system is ideal for all countries and all situations.

National Parties and State Parties

Meaning 🧐



Criteria recognised as National Party and State Party.



- Every party in the country has to register with the Election Commission.



- Large and established parties given some special facilities
- These parties are given a unique symbol.
- 'Recognised' by the Election Commission, therefore known as Recognised Political Parties.

National Parties

- 6% votes of total votes in Lok Sabha election or Assembly election in four states.
- And wins at least four seats in the lok sabha.

State Parties

- 6 % votes of total votes in a state legislative section.
- And wins at least two seats

Basics	BJP (Bharatiya Janata Party)	INC (Indian National Congress)	BSP (Bahujan Samaj Party)	AITC (All India Trinamool Congress)	CPI (Communist Party of India)	CPI-M (Communis Party of India - Marxist)	NCP (National Congress Party)
Founding Year	1980	1885	1984	1998	1925	1964	1999
Ideology	Ancient cultural values, Integral humanism and Antyodaya, Hindutva	Secularism, Welfare of weaker section and minorities, Centrist Party	Aims to represents and secure power for the Bahujan Samaj, Follows ideas of Shahu Maharaj, Phule, Naicker and Ambedkar	Committed to secularism and federalism	Marxism-Lenini sm, opposed successionism and communalism, stand for working class, farmers and poor.	Marxism-Leni nism, Opposes new economic policies and new trade.	Advocates democracy Gandhian secularism demands high offices in gov. to be confined to natural born citizens
Symbol	Lotus	Hand Palm with five fingers	Elephant	Flower and Grass	Sickle and Grains	Sickle and Hammer	Clock
Leader	Shyama Prasad Mukherjee	Jawaharlal Nehru	Kanshi Ram	Mamta Banerjee	—	—	—
Area/Region/ Present position	Formed NDA, presently ruling government.	Formed UPA in 2004, Ruled for a major period.	Main base in U.P. and formal presence in M.P., Chhattisgarh, Uttarakhand and Punjab.	In power in West Bengal, 4th largest party in Lok Sabha	Kerala, West Bengal, Punjab, Andhra Pradesh and T.N.	W.B., Kerala, Tripura	Maharashtra (major party), Meghalaya, Manipur and Assam

Challenges to Political Parties

Four major challenges which political parties face:

1. Lack of Internal democracy
2. Challenges of dynasty succession
3. Money and muscle power
4. Lack of meaningful choice

Explain



How can parties be reformed?



Before that we need to ask some questions.



- Are political parties willing to reform?
- If they are not willing, is it possible to force them to reform?

How can Parties be Reformed?

Some recent efforts and suggestions in our country to reform political parties and its leaders are:

- Constitutional amendment to check defection of elected representatives. (**Anti-Defection**)
- Now it is mandatory for every candidate who contest election to **file an affidavit giving details of his property and criminal cases.**
- Election Commission passed an order making it **necessary for political parties to hold their organisational elections and file their income tax returns.**

Suggestions to bring reform

- Law to regulate internal affairs.
- Quota in ticket distribution [$\frac{1}{3}$ to women]
- State funding of elections.

Way Forward

- Over regulation can be counter productive.
- People's participation and pressure can make the different.
- People willing for reform should join the politics.

The problem of bad politics can be solved by more and better politics 🤔



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